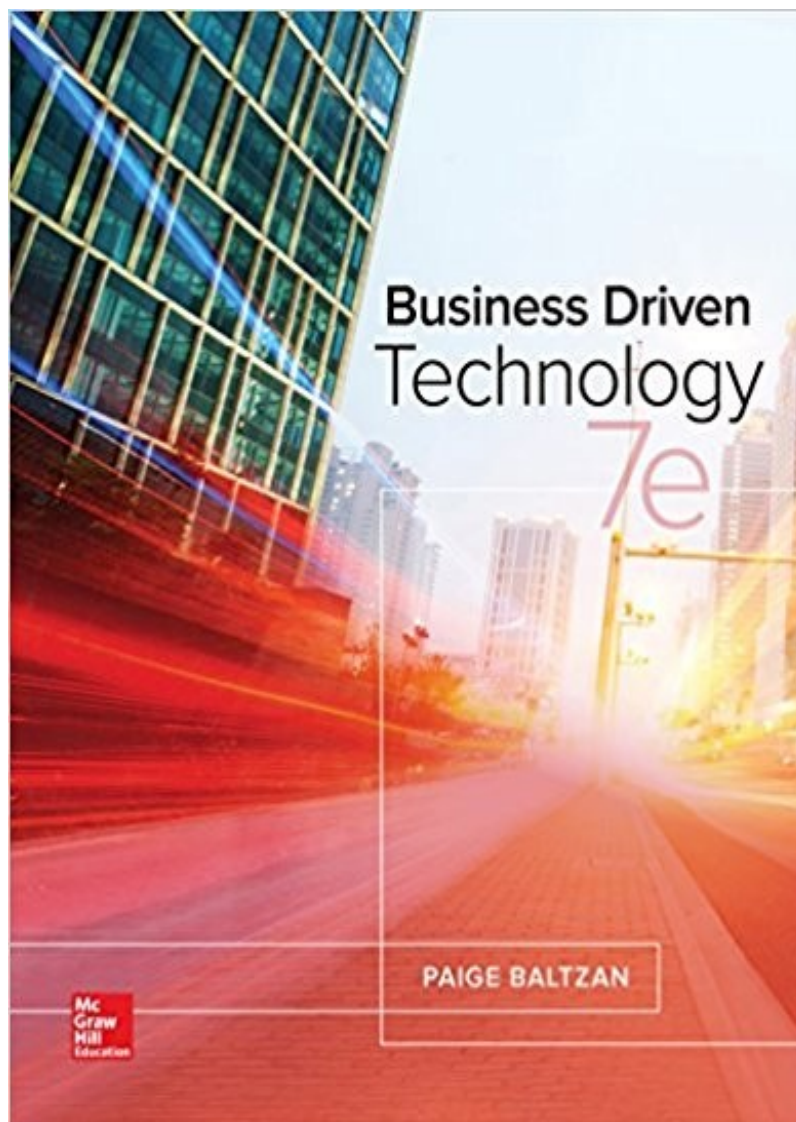


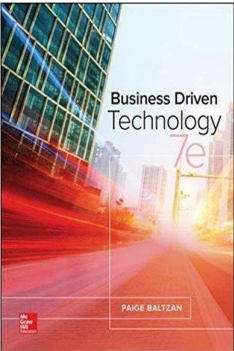
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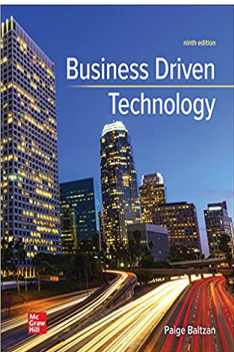
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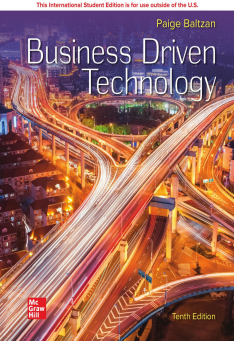
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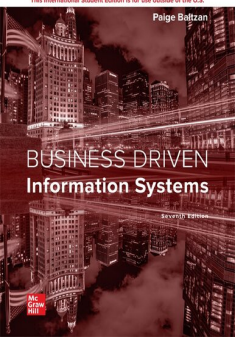
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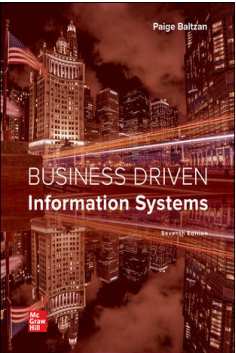
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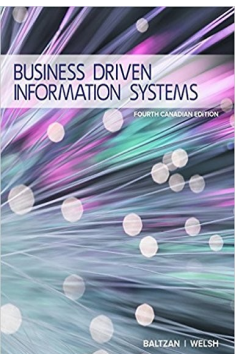
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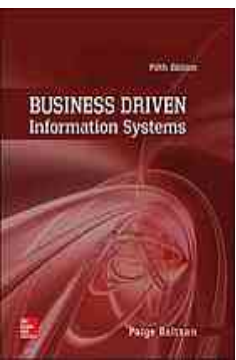
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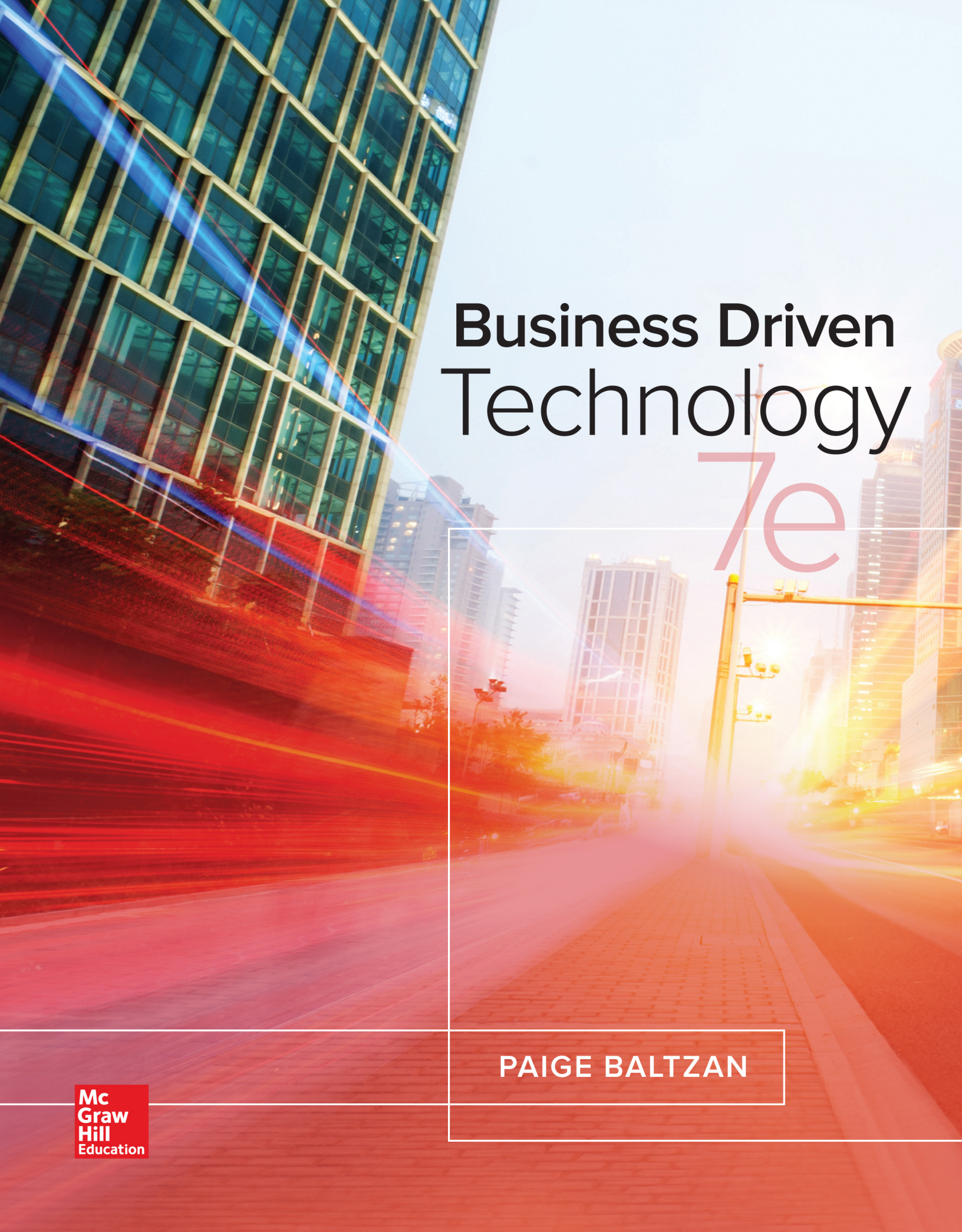
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Business Driven Technology 7e

PAIGE BALTZAN

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ABOUT THE AUTHOR

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Paige Baltzan is an Assistant Teaching Professor in the department of Business Information and Analytics at the Daniels College of Business at the University of Denver. She holds a BSBA specializing in Accounting/MIS from Bowling Green State University and an MBA specializing in MIS from the University of Denver. She is a coauthor of several books, including *Business Driven Information Systems*, *Essentials of Business Driven Information Systems*, and *I-Series*, and is a contributor to *Management Information Systems for the Information Age*.

Before joining the Daniels College faculty in 1999, Paige spent several years working for a large telecommunications company and an international consulting firm where she participated in client engagements in the United States as well as South America and Europe. Paige lives in Lakewood, Colorado, with her husband, Tony, and daughters, Hannah and Sophie.

THE TECHNOLOGY PLUG-INS

The overall goal of the Technology Plug-Ins is to provide additional information not covered in the text such as personal productivity using information technology, problem solving using Excel, and decision making using Access. These plug-ins also offer an all-in-one text to faculty, avoiding their having to purchase an extra book to support Microsoft Office. These plug-ins offer integration with the core chapters and provide critical knowledge using essential business applications, such as Microsoft Excel, Microsoft Access, and Microsoft Project with hands-on tutorials for comprehension and mastery. Plug-Ins T1 to T12 are located in McGraw-Hill Connect at <http://connect.mheducation.com>.

Plug-In	Description
T1. Personal Productivity Using IT	This plug-in covers a number of things to do to keep a personal computer running effectively and efficiently. The topics covered in this plug-in are: ■ Creating strong passwords. ■ Performing good file management. ■ Implementing effective backup and recovery strategies. ■ Using Zip files. ■ Writing professional emails. ■ Stopping spam. ■ Preventing phishing. ■ Detecting spyware. ■ Threads to instant messaging. ■ Increasing PC performance. ■ Using antivirus software. ■ Installing a personal firewall.
T2. Basic Skills Using Excel	This plug-in introduces the basics of using Microsoft Excel, a spreadsheet program for data analysis, along with a few fancy features. The topics covered in this plug-in are: ■ Workbooks and worksheets. ■ Working with cells and cell data. ■ Printing worksheets. ■ Formatting worksheets. ■ Formulas. ■ Working with charts and graphics.
T3. Problem Solving Using Excel	This plug-in provides a comprehensive tutorial on how to use a variety of Microsoft Excel functions and features for problem solving. The areas covered in this plug-in are: ■ Lists ■ Conditional Formatting ■ AutoFilter ■ Subtotals ■ PivotTables
T4. Decision Making Using Excel	This plug-in examines a few of the advanced business analysis tools used in Microsoft Excel that have the capability to identify patterns, trends, and rules, and create “what-if” models. The four topics covered in this plug-in are: ■ IF ■ Lookup ■ Goal Seek ■ Solver ■ Scenario Manager
T5. Designing Database Applications	This plug-in provides specific details on how to design relational database applications. One of the most efficient and powerful information management computer-based applications is the relational database. The topics covered in this plug-in are: ■ Entities and data relationships. ■ Documenting logical data relationships. ■ The relational data model. ■ Normalization.

Plug-in	Description
T6. Basic Skills Using Access	This plug-in focuses on creating a Microsoft Access database file. One of the most efficient information management computer-based applications is Microsoft Access. Access provides a powerful set of tools for creating and maintaining a relational database. The topics covered in this plug-in are: ■ Create a new database file. ■ Create and modify tables.
T7. Problem Solving Using Access	This plug-in provides a comprehensive tutorial on how to query a database in Microsoft Access. Queries are essential for problem solving, allowing a user to sort information, summarize data (display totals, averages, counts, and so on), display the results of calculations on data, and choose exactly which fields are shown. The topics in this plug-in are: ■ Create simple queries using the simple query wizard. ■ Create advanced queries using calculated fields. ■ Format results displayed in calculated fields.
T8. Decision Making Using Access	This plug-in provides a comprehensive tutorial on entering data in a well-designed form and creating functional reports using Microsoft Access. A form is essential to use for data entry and a report is an effective way to present data in a printed format. The topics in this plug-in are: ■ Creating, modifying, and running forms. ■ Creating, modifying, and running reports.
T9. Designing Web Pages	This plug-in provides a comprehensive assessment into the functional aspects of web design. Websites are beginning to look more alike and to employ the same metaphors and conventions. The web has now become an everyday thing whose design should not make users think. The topics in this plug-in are: ■ The World Wide Web. ■ Designing for the unknown(s). ■ The process of web design. ■ HTML basics. ■ Web fonts. ■ Web graphics.
T10. Creating Web Pages Using HTML	This plug-in provides an overview of creating web pages using the HTML language. HTML is a system of codes that you use to create interactive web pages. It provides a means to describe the structure of text-based information in a document—by denoting certain text as headings, paragraphs, lists, and so on. The topics in this plug-in are: ■ An introduction to HTML. ■ HTML tools. ■ Creating, saving, and viewing HTML documents. ■ Apply style tags and attributes. ■ Using fancy formatting. ■ Creating hyperlinks. ■ Displaying graphics.
T11. Creating Gantt Charts with Excel and Microsoft Project	This plug-in offers a quick and efficient way to manage projects. Excel and Microsoft Project are great for managing all phases of a project, creating templates, collaborating on planning processes, tracking project progress, and sharing information with all interested parties. The two topics in this plug-in are: ■ Creating Gantt Charts with Excel. ■ Creating Gantt Charts with Microsoft Project.

PREFACE

Unlike any other MIS text, *Business Driven Technology, 7e*, discusses various business initiatives first and how technology supports those initiatives second. The premise for this unique approach is that business initiatives should drive technology choices. Every discussion in the text first addresses the business needs and then addresses the technology that supports those needs.

Business Driven Technology offers you the flexibility to customize courses according to your needs and the needs of your students by covering only essential concepts and topics in the five core units, while providing additional in-depth coverage in the business and technology plug-ins.

Business Driven Technology contains 19 chapters (organized into five units), 12 business plug-ins, and 11 technology plug-ins offering you the ultimate flexibility in tailoring content to the exact needs of your MIS course. The unique construction of this text allows you to cover essential concepts and topics in the five core units while providing you with the ability to customize a course and explore certain topics in greater detail with the business and technology plug-ins.

Plug-ins are fully developed modules of text that include student learning outcomes, case studies, business vignettes, and end-of-chapter material such as key terms, individual and group questions and projects, and case study exercises.

We realize that instructors today require the ability to cover a blended mix of topics in their courses. While some instructors like to focus on networks and infrastructure throughout their course, others choose to focus on ethics and security. *Business Driven Technology* was developed to easily adapt to your needs. Each chapter and plug-in is independent so you can:

- Cover any or all of the *chapters* as they suit your purpose.
- Cover any or all of the *business plug-ins* as they suit your purpose.
- Cover any or all of the *technology plug-ins* as they suit your purpose.
- Cover the plug-ins in any order you wish.



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Connect MIS offers a number of powerful tools and features to make managing assignments easier, so faculty can spend more time teaching. With *Connect MIS*, students can engage with their coursework anytime and anywhere, making the learning process more accessible and efficient. *Connect MIS* offers you the features described next.

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The *Connect MIS* Instructor Library is your repository for additional resources to improve student engagement in and out of class. You can select and use any asset that enhances your lecture. The *Connect MIS* Instructor Library includes:

- Instructor's Manual with
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 - Case discussion points and solutions.
 - Answers to all chapter questions and cases.
 - Video guides—discussion points, questions and answers.
- PowerPoint Presentations with detail lecture notes.
- Solution files to all Apply Your Knowledge problems.

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Connect MIS keeps instructors informed about how each student, section, and class is performing, allowing for more productive use of lecture and office hours. The progress-tracking function enables you to:

- View scored work immediately and track individual or group performance with assignment and grade reports.
- Access an instant view of student or class performance relative to learning objectives.
- Collect data and generate reports required by many accreditation organizations, such as AACSB.

Lecture Capture

Increase the attention paid to lecture discussion by decreasing the attention paid to note taking. For an additional charge Lecture Capture offers new ways for students to focus on the in-class discussion, knowing they can revisit important topics later. Lecture Capture enables you to:

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Educators know that the more students can see, hear, and experience class resources, the better they learn. In fact, studies prove it. With Tegrity Campus, students quickly recall key moments by using Tegrity Campus's unique search feature. This search helps students efficiently find what they need, when they need it, across an entire semester of class recordings. Help turn all your students' study time into learning moments immediately supported by your lecture.

Assurance of Learning Ready

Many educational institutions today are focused on the notion of *assurance of learning*, an important element of some accreditation standards. *Business Driven Technology, 7e*, is designed specifically to support your assurance of learning initiatives with a simple yet powerful solution.

Each test bank question for *Business Driven Technology* maps to a specific chapter learning outcome/objective listed in the text. You can use our test bank software, EZ Test, or in *Connect MIS* to easily query for learning outcomes/objectives that directly relate to the learning objectives for your course. You can then use the reporting features of EZ Test to aggregate student results in similar fashion, making the collection and presentation of assurance of learning data simple and easy.

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Walkthrough

This text is organized around the traditional sequence of topics and concepts in information technology; however, the presentation of this material is nontraditional. That is to say, the text is divided into four major sections: (1) units, (2) chapters, (3) business plug-ins, and (4) technology plug-ins. This represents a substantial departure from existing traditional texts. The goal is to provide both students and faculty with only the most essential concepts and topical coverage in the text, while allowing faculty to customize a course by choosing from among a set of plug-ins that explore topics in more detail. All of the topics that form the core of the discipline are covered, including CRM, SCM, Porter's Five Forces Model, value chain analysis, competitive advantage, information security, and ethics.

Business Driven Technology

includes four major components:

- 5 Core Units
- 19 Chapters
- 12 Business Plug-Ins
- 11 Technology Plug-Ins

UNITS

1. Achieving Business Success

Chapter 1: Business Driven Technology
Chapter 2: Identifying Competitive Advantages
Chapter 3: Strategic Initiatives for Implementing Competitive Advantages
Chapter 4: Measuring the Success of Strategic Initiatives
Chapter 5: Organizational Structures That Support Strategic Initiatives

2. Exploring Business Intelligence

Chapter 6: Valuing and Storing Organizational Information—Databases
Chapter 7: Accessing Organizational Information—Data Warehouses
Chapter 8: Understanding Big Data and Its Impact on Business

3. Streamlining Business Operations

Chapter 9: Enabling the Organization—Decision Making
Chapter 10: Extending the Organization—Supply Chain Management
Chapter 11: Building a Customer-Centric Organization—Customer Relationship Management
Chapter 12: Integrating the Organization from End to End—Enterprise Resource Planning

4. Building Innovation

Chapter 13: Creating Innovative Organizations
Chapter 14: Ebusiness
Chapter 15: Creating Collaborative Partnerships
Chapter 16: Integrating Wireless Technology in Business

5. Transforming Organizations

Chapter 17: Developing Software to Streamline Operations
Chapter 18: Methodologies for Supporting Agile Organizations
Chapter 19: Managing Organizational Projects

BUSINESS PLUG-INS

B1	Business Basics	B7	Ethics
B2	Business Process	B8	Operations Management
B3	Hardware and Software Basics	B9	Sustainable MIS Infrastructures
B4	MIS Infrastructures	B10	Business Intelligence
B5	Networks and Telecommunications	B11	Global Information Systems
B6	Information Security	B12	Global Trends

TECHNOLOGY PLUG-INS (CONNECT ONLY)

T1	Personal Productivity Using IT	T7	Problem Solving Using Access
T2	Basic Skills Using Excel	T8	Decision Making Using Access
T3	Problem Solving Using Excel	T9	Designing Web Pages
T4	Decision Making Using Excel	T10	Creating Web Pages Using HTML
T5	Designing Database Applications	T11	Creating Gantt Charts with Excel and Microsoft Project
T6	Basic Skills Using Access		
Apply Your Knowledge Projects		Notes	
Glossary		Index	

Format, Features, and Highlights

Business Driven Technology, 7e, is state of the art in its discussions, presents concepts in an easy-to-understand format, and allows students to be active participants in learning. The dynamic nature of information technology requires all students, more specifically business students, to be aware of both current and emerging technologies. Students are facing complex subjects and need a clear, concise explanation to be able to understand and use the concepts throughout their careers. By engaging students with numerous case studies, exercises, projects, and questions that enforce concepts, *Business Driven Technology* creates a unique learning experience for both faculty and students.

- **Logical Layout.** Students and faculty will find the text well organized with the topics flowing logically from one unit to the next and from one chapter to the next. The definition of each term is provided before it is covered in the chapter and an extensive glossary is included at the back of the text. Each core unit offers a comprehensive opening case study, introduction, learning outcomes, unit summary, closing case studies, key terms, and making business decision questions. The plug-ins follow the same pedagogical elements with the exception of the exclusion of opening case and closing case studies in the technology plug-ins.
- **Thorough Explanations.** Complete coverage is provided for each topic that is introduced. Explanations are written so that students can understand the ideas presented and relate them to other concepts presented in the core units and plug-ins.
- **Solid Theoretical Base.** The text relies on current theory and practice of information systems as they relate to the business environment. Current academic and professional journals and websites upon which the text is based are found in the References at the end of the book—a road map for additional, pertinent readings that can be the basis for learning beyond the scope of the unit, chapter, or plug-in.
- **Material to Encourage Discussion.** All units contain a diverse selection of case studies and individual and group problem-solving activities as they relate to the use of information technology in business. Two comprehensive cases at the end of each unit reflect the concepts from the chapters. These cases encourage students to consider what concepts have been presented and then apply those concepts to a situation they might find in an organization. Different people in an organization can view the same facts from different points of view and the cases will force students to consider some of those views.
- **Flexibility in Teaching and Learning.** While most textbooks that are “text only” leave faculty on their own when it comes to choosing cases, *Business Driven Technology* goes much further. Several options are provided to faculty with case selections from a variety of sources including *CIO*, *Harvard Business Journal*, *Wired*, *Forbes*, and *Time*, to name just a few. Therefore, faculty can use the text alone, the text and a complete selection of cases, or anything in between.
- **Integrative Themes.** Several themes recur throughout the text, which adds integration to the material. Among these themes are value-added techniques and methodologies, ethics and social responsibility, globalization, and gaining a competitive advantage. Such topics are essential to gaining a full understanding of the strategies that a business must recognize, formulate, and in turn implement. In addition to addressing these in the chapter material, many illustrations are provided for their relevance to business practice. These include brief examples in the text as well as more detail presented in the corresponding plug-in(s) (business or technical).

Visual Content Map

Visual Content Map

Located at the beginning of the text and serving as a logical outline, the visual content map illustrates the relationship between each unit and its associated plug-ins.

Introduction

Information is everywhere. Most organizations value information as a strategic asset. Organizational success depends heavily on the ability to gather and analyze information about operations, suppliers, customers, and markets. Information can answer such questions as who are your best and worst customers? How much inventory do you need to meet demand? Where can you source the cheapest raw materials? How can you increase sales or reduce costs? Answering these questions incorrectly can lead directly to business failure. Estimating too many buyers will lead to an excess of inventory; estimating too few buyers will potentially lead to lost sales due to lack of product (resulting in even more lost revenues).

Understanding the direct impact information has on an organization's bottom line is crucial to running a successful business. This text focuses on information, business, technology, and the integrated set of activities used to run most organizations. Many of these activities are the hallmarks of business today—supply chain management, customer relationship management, enterprise resource planning, outsourcing, integration, ebusiness, and others. The five core units of this text cover these important activities in detail. Each unit is divided into chapters that provide individual learning outcomes and case studies. In addition to the five core units, there are technology and business “plug-ins” (see Figure Unit 1.1) that further explore topics presented in the five core units.

The chapters in Unit 1 are:

- **Chapter One**—Business Driven Technology.
- **Chapter Two**—Identifying Competitive Advantages.
- **Chapter Three**—Strategic Initiatives for Implementing Competitive Advantages.
- **Chapter Four**—Measuring the Success of Strategic Initiatives.
- **Chapter Five**—Organizational Structures That Support Strategic Initiatives.

Introduction and Learning Outcomes

Introduction. Located after the Unit Opening Case, the introduction familiarizes students with the overall tone of the chapters. Thematic concepts are also broadly defined.

Learning Outcomes. These outcomes focus on what students should learn and be able to answer upon completion of the chapter or plug-in.

Introduction

Decision making and problem solving in today's electronic world encompass large-scale, opportunity-oriented, strategically focused solutions. The traditional "cookbook" approach to decisions simply will not work in the ebusiness world. Decision-making and problem-solving abilities are now the most sought-after traits in up-and-coming executives. To put it mildly, decision makers and problem solvers have limitless career potential.

Ebusiness is the conducting of business on the Internet, not only buying and selling, but also serving customers and collaborating with business partners. (Unit Four discusses ebusiness in detail.) With the fast growth of information technology and the accelerated use of the Internet, ebusiness is quickly becoming standard. This unit focuses on technology to help make decisions, solve problems, and find new innovative opportunities. The unit highlights how to bring people together with the best IT processes and tools in complete, flexible solutions that can seize business opportunities (see Figure Unit 3.1). The chapters in Unit 3 are:

- **Chapter Nine**—Enabling the Organization—Decision Making.
- **Chapter Ten**—Extending the Organization—Supply Chain Management.
- **Chapter Eleven**—Building a Customer-centric Organization—Customer Relationship Management.
- **Chapter Twelve**—Integrating the Organization from End to End—Enterprise Resource Planning.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- 9.1.** Explain the importance of decision making for managers at each of the three primary organization levels along with the associated decision characteristics.
- 9.2.** Classify the different operational support systems, managerial support systems, and strategic support

systems, and explain how managers can use these systems to make decisions and gain competitive advantages.

- 9.3.** Describe artificial intelligence, and identify its five main types.

Unit Opening Case and Opening Case Study Questions

Unit Opening Case. To enhance student interest, each unit begins with an opening case study that highlights an organization that has been time-tested and value-proven in the business world. This feature serves to fortify concepts with relevant examples of outstanding companies. Discussion of the case is threaded throughout the chapters in each unit.

Opening Case Study Questions. Located at the end of each chapter, pertinent questions connect the Unit Opening Case with important chapter concepts.

UNIT ONE OPENING CASE



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Buy Experiences, Not Things

Retail is one of the most competitive and stingiest industries in America boasting some of the most dissatisfied workers across the board. Walmart Stores employees began a week-long strike in Miami, Boston, and the San Francisco Bay Area to publicly display their immense dissatisfaction with the multinational corporation. Employees at Amazon.com fulfillment center in Leipzig, Germany went on strike demanding higher wages and better benefits. Just search retail strikes and you will find numerous examples of dissatisfied employees doing what they can to improve their situations. However, there is one company that will not appear on the list – Costco Wholesale!

Costco Wholesale, the second-largest retailer in the U.S. behind Walmart, is an anomaly in a world where retailers are closing their doors due to the inability to compete with online prices. Retail stores such as Aeropostale, Sears, and Macy's are all feeling the pressure of the online marketplaces of today's digital world. Costco requires a \$55-a-year membership fee for access to its massive warehouses supplied floor to ceiling with generous portions of everything from olive oil to paper towels. While many businesses are losing customers to the Internet Costco's sales have grown 40 percent and its stock price has doubled.

Treating employees exceptionally well is the secret to Costco's success. Costco employees make an average of \$20 an hour, not including overtime and eighty-eight percent of Costco

OPENING CASE STUDY QUESTIONS

1. What is the ebusiness model implemented by Slack?
2. What is the revenue model implemented by Slack?

Projects and Case Studies

Case Studies. This text is packed with case studies illustrating how a variety of prominent organizations and businesses have successfully implemented many of this text's concepts. All cases promote critical thinking. Company profiles are especially appealing and relevant to your students, helping to stir classroom discussion and interest.

APPLY YOUR KNOWLEDGE

Apply Your Knowledge Project Overview

Project Number	Project Name	Project Type	Plug-In	Focus Area	Project Level	Skill Set	Page Number
1	Financial Destiny	Excel	T2	Personal Budget	Introductory	Formulas	AYK.4
2	Cash Flow	Excel	T2	Cash Flow	Introductory	Formulas	AYK.4
3	Technology Budget	Excel	T1, T2	Hardware and Software	Introductory	Formulas	AYK.4
4	Tracking Donations	Excel	T2	Employee Relationships	Introductory	Formulas	AYK.4
5	Convert Currency	Excel	T2	Global Commerce	Introductory	Formulas	AYK.5
6	Cost Comparison	Excel	T2	Total Cost of Ownership	Introductory	Formulas	AYK.5
7	Time Management	Excel or Project	T12	Project Management	Introductory	Gantt Charts	AYK.6
8	Maximize Profit	Excel	T2, T4	Strategic Analysis	Intermediate	Formulas or Solver	AYK.6
9	Security Analysis	Excel	T3	Filtering Data	Intermediate	Conditional Formatting, Autofilter, Subtotal	AYK.7
10	Gathering Data	Excel	T3	Data Analysis	Intermediate	Conditional Formatting	AYK.8
11	Scanner System	Excel	T2	Strategic Analysis	Intermediate	Formulas	AYK.8

Chapter Three Case: Amazon Drone Knocking

Using drones to drop off packages could be great for buyers, who might want to get as fast as humanly possible. Back in 2013, when Amazon revealed plans to begin delivering via flying drones through Prime Air, some seemed skeptical about the reality of the system. Recently, Amazon doubled down on those claims by releasing information on or drones in action, and it is seriously impressive.

A new video presented by former Top Gear host Jeremy Clarkson (who is working on Amazon), takes us through the entire process, from ordering, to warehouse launch, to delivery. The drone looks a lot different from the one Amazon showed us a couple of years ago. This one is commercial and streamlined look, and instead of showing the package hanging in open air, the drone hides the item in a square compartment. Just Google Amazon Prime Air Drone video to see for yourself this amazing new drone that will dramatically impact the supply chain.

According to Amazon, the drone reaches a height of about 400 feet in vertical mode, then switches to horizontal mode to travel up to 15 miles away from the warehouse. During the flight, the drone uses what Amazon calls "sense and avoid technology" to avoid collisions with other aircraft.

Toward the end of the video, the drone alights atop an Amazon logo in the yard of a customer and spits out the package (in this case, shoes) and then takes off in a matter of seconds. The process, which Amazon is careful to note is real and not a simulation, comes off as seamless. The prospect of drone deliveries seem like something that will be viable just a few months away.

However, despite the encouraging footage, Amazon is still holding off on announcing when its drones will take to the skies. On the updated Prime Air page featuring the new video, a message reads, "Putting Prime Air into service will take some time, but we will definitely have the regulatory support needed to realize our vision."

The FAA's Unmanned Aircraft Systems (UAS) Registration Task Force Aviation Rulemaking Committee is still hammering out rules for private and commercial drone use in U.S. airspace, and the lack of a specific launch timeline for Prime Air is understandable. But based on the video and the increasing clarity that Prime Air might not be a mere marketing stunt but a real look at the future of Amazon deliveries.

Retailers Racing to the Drone Games

Wal-Mart recently applied to U.S. regulators for permission to test drones for home delivery pickup and checking warehouse inventories, a sign it plans to go head-to-head with Amazon in the race to use drones to fill and deliver online orders.

Wal-Mart wants to start using drones in an effort to create a more efficient supply chain by connecting their network of stores, distribution centers, fulfillment centers and transportation. The world's largest retailer by revenue has for several months been conducting indoor tests of its unmanned aircraft systems (drones) and is now seeking for the first time to test them outdoors. In addition to having drones take inventory of trailers outside its warehouses, Wal-Mart is also looking at other tasks aimed at making its distribution system more efficient. Wal-Mart is asking the Federal Aviation Administration for permission to research drone use in "deliveries to customers at Wal-Mart stores, as well as to consumer homes." The move comes as Amazon, Google and other companies

Apply Your Knowledge. At the end of this text is a set of 33 projects aimed at reinforcing the business initiatives explored in the text.

These projects help to develop the application and problem-solving skills of your students through challenging and creative business-driven scenarios.

Making Business Decisions

Making Business Decisions.

Small scenario-driven projects help students focus on decision making as they relate to the topical elements in the chapters and plug-ins.

* MAKING BUSINESS DECISIONS

1. Two Trillion Rows of Data Analyzed Daily—No Problem

eBay is the world's largest online marketplace, with 97 million global users selling anything to anyone at a yearly total of \$62 billion—more than \$2,000 every second. Of course with this many sales, eBay is collecting the equivalent of the Library of Congress worth of data every three days that must be analyzed to run the business successfully. Luckily, eBay discovered Tableau!

Tableau started at Stanford when Chris Stolte, a computer scientist; Pat Hanrahan, an Academy Award-winning professor; and Christian Chabot, a savvy business leader, decided to solve the problem of helping ordinary people understand big data. The three created Tableau, which bridged two computer science disciplines: computer graphics and databases. No more need to write code or understand the relational database keys and categories; users simply drag and drop pictures of what they want to analyze. Tableau has become one of the most successful data visualization tools on the market, winning multiple awards, international expansion, and millions in revenue and spawning multiple new inventions.

Tableau is revolutionizing business analytics, and this is only the beginning. Visit the Tableau website and become familiar with the tool by watching a few of the demos. Once you have a good understanding of the tool, create three questions eBay might be using Tableau to answer, including the analysis of its sales data to find patterns, business insights, and trends.

2. Track Your Life

With wearable technology, you can track your entire life. Nike's Fuelband and Jawbone's Up tracks all of your physical activity, caloric burn, and sleep patterns. You can track your driving patterns, tooth-brushing habits, and even laundry status. The question now becomes how to track all of your trackers.

A new company called Exist incorporates tracking devices with weather data, music choices, Netflix favorites, and Twitter activity all in one digital dashboard. Exist wants to understand every area of your life and provide correlation information between such things as your personal productivity and mood. As the different types of data expand, so will the breadth of correlations Exist can point out. For instance, do you tweet more when you are working at home? If so, does this increase productivity? Exist wants to track all of your trackers and analyze the information to help you become more efficient and more effective.

Create a digital dashboard for tracking your life. Choose four areas you want to track and determine three ways you would measure each area. For example, if you track eating habits, you might want to measure calories and place unacceptable levels in red and acceptable levels in green. Once completed, determine whether you can find any correlations among the areas in your life.

3. Butterfly Effects

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